



Edward himself wrote in his diary of the “awful and ghastly suspense” of the situation.

At last the new King made up his mind. If the woman he loved could not be queen, he would abdicate—meaning he would give up the throne forever.

On December 11, 1936, Edward VIII spoke on the radio to tell the world of his decision. “I have found it impossible ... to discharge my duties as king as I would wish to do without the help and support of the woman I love,” he said. From this moment on, Elizabeth’s life changed forever. The next day, she saw a crowd outside her home. Someone shouted, “Long live King Albert!”